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Boundaries between producer and consumer will blur. India will be home to millions of prosumers—those who consume and produce simultaneously

THE FUTURE OF CONSUMPTION

By 2047, the real revolution will be that of the Indian consumer. She will emerge as a powerful force shaping markets, ethics, and innovation

► **IN 1947, WON** its political freedom. By 1991, it began a journey of economic liberation. In 2025, it is navigating the turbulence of a digital age. But by 2047 the real revolution will be that of the Indian consumer. She will emerge as a powerful force shaping markets, ethics, and innovation. From being price-conscious to value-driven, from underserved to over-informed, the consumer will be a sovereign citizen.

DEMOGRAPHIC DIVIDEND

In 2047, India's population will likely be over 1.6 billion. Over 1.3 billion Indians will be online, and close to a billion will be using smart devices embedded with AI agents that anticipate needs, preferences, and spending behaviour. Consumption will be shaped by data but driven by dignity. Consumers will demand fairness, privacy, and ethical engagement.

As digital literacy becomes universal, even rural consumers will lead trends. Vernacular commerce platforms, voice-based interfaces, and AI-driven virtual assistants will democratise access

to services. The tyranny of location will be dead.

VALUE-CONSCIOUS, PURPOSE-DRIVEN CONSUMER

The consumer of 2047 will be assertive. They will chase holistic value: quality, ethics, transparency, sustainability, and brand purpose. Greenwashing, dark patterns, and manipulative pricing will increasingly come under the scanner. Brands that fail to walk the talk—on ESG goals, labour practices, or digital ethics—will be boycotted not just on Twitter, but in wallets.

This will give rise to a more domestically rooted consumption pattern, one that celebrates Indian crafts, local supply chains, organic farming, and climate-smart choices.

THE AGE OF PREDICTIVE CONSUMPTION

By 2047, AI will curate, personalise, and negotiate on behalf of the consumer. Smart fridges will reorder groceries based on consumption patterns. Personal finance bots will suggest tailored insurance and investment products. Health wearables will trigger proactive service delivery for everything.

But this will come with risks.